

Prebid Evaluation Publift vs. Mobalytics

ADS TEAM



Background

Publift is currently our primary partner for rembrandt (indirect) inventory via a prebid setup, chosen for their established SSP and DSP relationships and ability to run a competitive auction without heavy legal and operational overhead. However, Publift operates on an estimated ~15% revenue commission.

With the Mobalytics acquisition, we now have the opportunity to leverage an in-house prebid stack, presenting a strategic alternative with potential margin and control upside.

Problem Statement

Which prebid solution should Faceit adopt going forward: Publift or Mobalytics?



Comparative Analysis

Mobalytics

Pros

- Direct relationships with SSPs and DSPs
- Full transparency on payments, reporting, and fees
- Zero revenue commission
- Internal ownership with long-term strategic value

Cons

- Market level of understanding
- Potential delays onboarding new SSPs/DSPs due to EFG legal processes
 - a. *Open question whether this is a real blocker if key partners are already onboarded*

Publift

Pros

- End-to-end SSP / DSP onboarding and managing
- Fully managed optimisation strategy
- Mature and proven operational workflows

Cons

- Unsuitable for direct deals
- Hidden SSP/DSP fees
- ~15% revenue commission
- Less control over auction mechanics

Simple Setup

1. One Sticky Footer:
 - a. 728x90
 - b. 300x50
 - c. 320x50
 - d. 300x100
 - e. 320x100
2. Viewability low as the banner refresh at each page
3. Anti ad blocker enabled on both side: **Blockthrough**
4. Currently the total inventory split is 60% Moba 40% Publift but is not consistent per country

Proposed Approach

Run an A/B test comparing Mobalytics Prebid vs. Publift Prebid on CSStats as it's the ideal environment for has sufficient traffic to reach statistical significance while minimising revenue risk to the core platform.

Constraints: as CSStats lack of experiment tools, we won't be able to split the inventory in an exact 50/50, to determine the winning prebid implementation.

How do we measure success?

We can't use Net Revenues as we can't provide an apple to apple comparison.



Methodology

Revenue Index = Fill-rate × eCPM across countries in tier

After an initial analysis, we observed low eCPMs alongside unusually high fill rates from Publift compared to Mobalytics, which did not align with expected performance outcomes. Following a deeper investigation, we identified that Publift maintains a GAM line item used as a placeholder for unfilled impressions.

This artificially inflates the fill-rate reported in the Publift dashboard.

New Metric

Revenue by Page View = total revenues / page views split by geo



Results

Data: 24.02 - 04.03

	MOBLYTICS			PUBLIFT			
Geo	Revenue	Views	RPV	Revenue*	Views	RPV	Winner
Tier 1	\$84.45	261,122	0.000323	\$59.82	252,826	0.000237	Moba (+36%)
Tier 2	\$78.33	581,058	0.000135	\$87.64	531,579	0.000165	Publift (+21%)
Tier 3	\$32.63	548,913	0.000059	\$33.54	570,006	0.000059	Tie

Tier	MOBA eCPM	Publift eCPM
Tier 1	\$0.323	\$0.237
Tier 2	\$0.135	\$0.165
Tier 3	\$0.059	\$0.059

* Publift revenues are gross



Next Steps

The test on CSStats generated enough data to demonstrate a significant revenue uplift. For this reason, from a product perspective, it is worth validating the same approach on FACEIT.

- NEW: Validate the Tier 1 countries in Faceit with a 50/50 experiment
- Launch the Moba prebid outstream

Appendix

- PRD: https://docs.google.com/document/d/1YsfG_RE4v9Cohn4lh_UCd7sKiabNWz77zh8KTzD7INM/edit?tab=t.0
- Data sourcers:
 - GAM 21974715207 (Mobalitics)
https://admanager.google.com/21974715207#reports/interactive/detail/report_id=6614982191
 - GAM 41188963 (Faceit / Publift)
https://admanager.google.com/41188963#reports/interactive/detail/report_id=6904237537
 - Google Analytics (CSStats):
<https://analytics.google.com/analytics/web/#/analysis/a248119971p343064518/edit/fX0k7rObSrS68Ww0sQK2Jw>
 - Data Calculations File:
https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1r2od3G1X-hlUg55wD45kqW9mSacibV0f0m5f_rPv0rg/edit?gid=2141888874#gid=2141888874